NICONET™

NICHOLSON STAFF INTRANET · STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

SOP · N3-V · VOIDS

Voids workflow

The Move-In Prep, N3 Voids and the hand-over

Your void work arrives in NicoNet as an online Move-In Prep from your manager, with a walk-through video so there is no ambiguity. You put right every line, follow N3 Voids every time, and finish by certifying the home ready for the cleaner. That certificate is yours.

WHO IT IS FOR

Void operatives preparing a home for move-in, and the managers who build the prep and audit the hand-over.

WHERE TO FIND IT

NicoNet › SOP, under the instructional film. Read it in full before your first job, then keep it to hand.

DOWNLOAD NICONET™

Scan with your phone camera to download NicoNet from the App Store or Google Play (published by Nicholson Lettings Limited). Sign in with your work email and the six-digit code we email you.

living.nicholsongroup.co.uk/get/niconet

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PURPOSE

1 Why we work this way

Every void day is rent lost. The goal is simple: the home ready, perfect, on the move-in date, with nothing left for the cleaner or the tenant to find.

STAGE	WHEN	WHO	IN THE APP
V1 Check-out inspection 1	Four weeks before the tenant leaves	Manager	Issues listed; works beyond void work raised early
V2 Check-out inspection 2	Two weeks before	Manager	Progress; pre-vacation works
V3 Final check-out	Last day, 11:00	Manager	Keys, meters, final condition, walk-through filmed
V4 Move-In Prep	During the void	**You, the void team**	Every line fixed with an after photo; N3 Voids; hand-over
V5 Clean	After your hand-over	Cleaner	Instructed automatically when you certify
V6 Move-In Quality Check	Before release	Manager	Certified ready for occupation
V7 Move-In Meeting	Move-in day, 3pm–5pm	Lettings	Caveats gone through with the tenant

Standard operating procedures

N3 Voids is the list of standard works we do in every void, every time, whether or not they are on the prep. That is why they are called standard operating procedures: they are non-negotiable.

RECEIVING WORK

2 How your work reaches you

An alert

When the manager submits a Move-In Prep to you, you get a push: “Move-in prep: [home] – watch the walk-through, fix every line with an after photo, complete N3 Voids, test appliances, hot water and sockets, then hand over by [date].”

Where it is

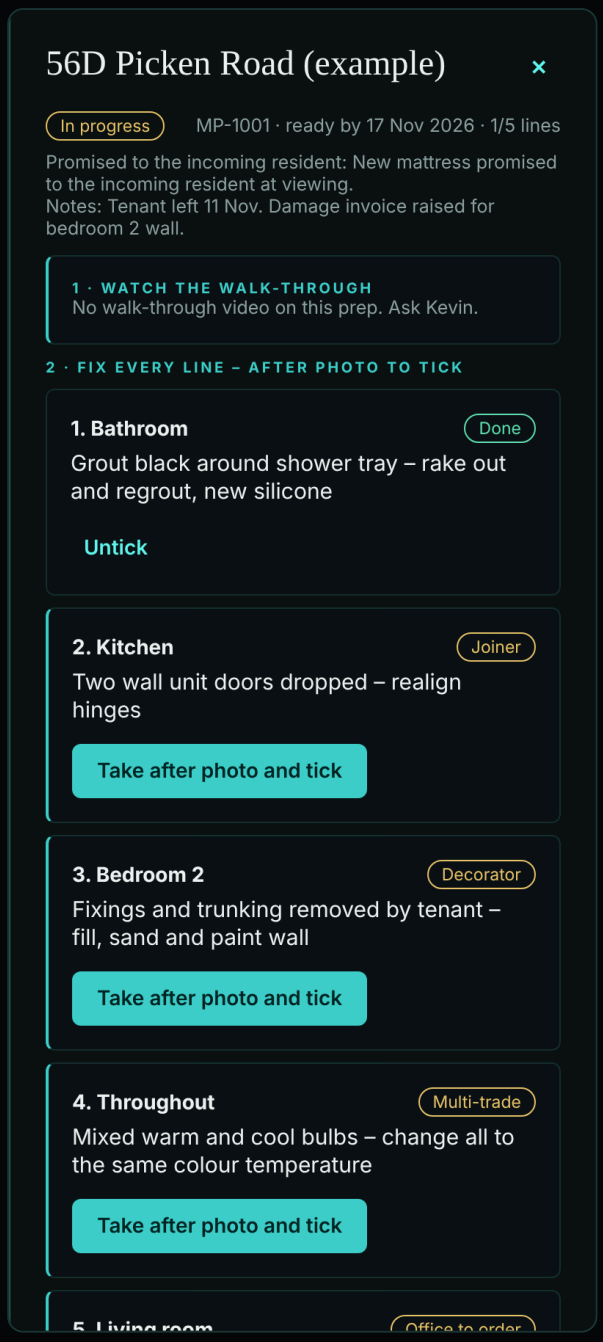
Work › Move-in prep. Each prep shows the address, the reference (MP-1001), the date it must be ready by, the move-in date, how many lines are done, any **promises** made to the incoming tenant and the manager’s notes.

Your void stages

The void’s stages also show in **Today › My jobs** under Void works, with their due dates. Anything behind shows in red.

Before you start

Sign the keys out in Keys & tools. Check in under Lone working if you are alone. Read N3 Voids (SOP › Voids) and watch the Voids film.



NicoNet › Move-in prep

THE WORK

3 Working through the prep

1. **Watch the walk-through video**

   The manager films the home room by room, pointing at each issue as they say it. Watch it in full before you start – it is the brief.

2. **Read every line**

   One line per issue: the room, what is wrong and what to do, the trade, and the manager's clip or photo of the issue. Rooms run Kitchen, Bathroom, En-suite, Living room, Bedrooms, Hallway & landing, Throughout, External & communal.

3. **Put it right**

   Protect, then paint. Dust sheets down, work to N3 Voids, make good.

4. **Tick it with an after photo**

   Press **Take after photo and tick** on the line. The camera opens; photograph the finished work. A line cannot be ticked without an after photo. Ticked by mistake? **Untick**.

5. **Complete N3 Voids**

   Every standard on the N3 list, in every void, whether or not it is on the prep.

6. **Test everything**

   Switch on every appliance, run the hot water, plug into every socket. The tenant must never be the first to find a fault.

7. **Clear out**

   Materials and tools removed, a brush and wipe through, keys back at the office.

LINES SENT BACK

If the manager audits your work and is not satisfied, the lines come back to you unticked with what is wrong, and you get an alert. Put them right and tick them again.

EXTRA WORKS

4 Works beyond void work

Not your job – and not on your prep

Anything beyond normal void work – new floors, a kitchen or worktops, joinery – is raised by the manager as a separate extra-works job (W1, W2…) for the right trade, so it does not hold you up.

Done early

The manager raises them at the check-out inspections wherever possible, so they are done during the outgoing tenant's notice period. They must be finished at least **24 hours before move-in**; NicoNet refuses a later date.

If you are given one

An extra-works job appears in your My jobs with an alert. It is closed like maintenance: **Start job** (clock on), before photos, **Stop clock**, after photos, what you did, **Complete job**. Management signs it off.

The rules

The prep cannot be submitted until the manager has raised extra works or confirmed there are none. Extra works still open on their due date are flagged to management at 07:25 every morning.



Raising extra works on a void stage

DEFECTS

5 Report a defect now

Found a defect that is not on the prep and that you cannot fix? Tell the office immediately – so it can be put right without affecting the move-in goal.

1. **Open the prep**
   Work › Move-in prep › the home.

2. **Press Report a defect now**
   At the foot of the prep.

3. **Say where and what**
   The room, and what is wrong: “Kitchen – worktop joint swollen by the sink, needs replacing, joiner required.”

4. **Send to the office now**
   Management get an urgent alert – “Defect found at [home] – act now” – and it is recorded on the prep notes.

Also tell

Blinds stained: tell the cleaner before the clean; if they cannot be cleaned they are reordered.
Appliance not working: the office the same day.
Anything that will delay move-in: the Voids & Works Manager the same day.

NEVER

Leave a defect for the cleaner or the tenant to find, or hand over a home you know is not right.

HAND-OVER

6 The hand-over: you certify it

When every line is ticked, confirm each statement, type your full name and press **I verify – hand over to the cleaner**.

YOU CONFIRM	WHAT IT MEANS
Every line on this Move-In Prep is complete, with an after photo	Nothing left on the list.
Every issue shown in the walk-through video has been put right	Including anything on the video not written as a line.
N3 Voids is complete in full	Every standard, every time.
Appliances switched on and working, hot water running, every socket tested	You have turned everything on and plugged into every socket.
All materials and tools removed; brush and wipe through done	The cleaner arrives to an empty home.
Keys back at the office	Every key accounted for.

> "I verify that I have completed and personally checked every line of this Move-In Prep, every issue shown in the walk-through video and every N3 Voids standard, that I have tested the appliances, hot water and every socket, and that this home is ready for the cleaner."

ONCE YOU PRESS IT, IT IS ON YOU

You are certifying the work is complete – each and every item, checked and triple-checked. Your name, the time and what you confirmed are recorded. Don't press it until you would be happy for the tenant to walk in.

AFTER

7 What happens next

1. **The cleaner is instructed**

   Automatically, the moment you press I verify. The V4 Move-In Prep and N3 stages are marked complete in My jobs.

2. **Management is alerted**

   “Ready for the cleaner: [home]”. If no cleaner is allocated, management is told to allocate one now.

3. **The audit**

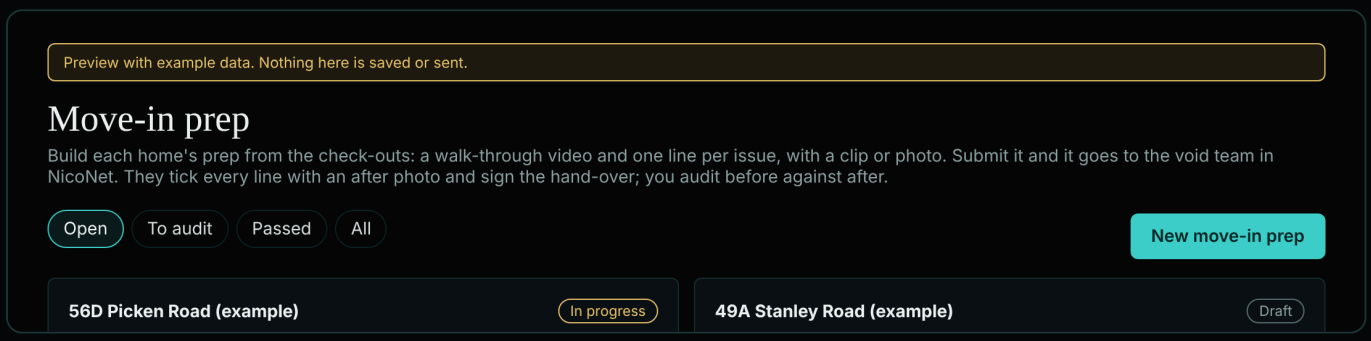
   The manager compares your after photos against each issue, line by line. **Pass – ready for the cleaner**, or the lines that are not right come back to you with the reason.

4. **The clean and the quality check**

   The cleaner cleans to N3 Cleaning and the Cleaning Matrix. Then the manager carries out the Move-In Quality Check and certifies the home ready for occupation. Anything that fails comes back to the team responsible.

5. **Move-in**

   The tenant arrives at 3pm–5pm on move-in day to the home you prepared.



What management sees: NicoMGT › Move-in prep, with your after photos against each issue

SOP · N3-V

N3 The Nicholson Non-Negotiables

Every move-in prep includes every item below, whether or not it appears on the Move-In Prep Checklist. The checklist tells you what is different about this home; N3 tells you what is the same in every home. Both are done before the keys go back.

Every void, every time

These are done on every move-in prep, regardless of the checklist.

Protect, then paint

Dust sheet all floors and furniture before you paint. Paint on floors costs the cleaners hours.

Hand over clean

Remove all materials and tools and give the home a brief dust and brush through, so the cleaners start on a clean slate.

Keys back to the office

When you have finished, return the keys to the office.

N3-V Standard works in every void

BATHROOM

- ☐ Silicone the perimeter of the floor.
- ☐ Silicone the perimeter of the ceiling.
- ☐ Silicone the basin, bath, bath panel and shower tray.
- ☐ Silicone up the corner of the bath to the height of the shower head.
- ☐ Fit a white plastic trim to the bath so the shower screen cannot open out over the floor.
- ☐ Change the shower or bath screen seal if it is discoloured.
- ☐ Toilet seat fitted square, secure and the correct shape for the pan.
- ☐ Grout missing on floor or walls: you must regrout.
- ☐ Bleach won't clean the grout around the shower or bath: rake it out and regrout.
- ☐ Taps and plugs discoloured: respray.
- ☐ Toilet roll holder square and secure, not loose.
- ☐ All LED lighting secured correctly.
- ☐ Shower mixer taps change temperature correctly.

KITCHEN

- ☐ New silicone to the worktops and around the sink.
- ☐ Colour-fill butt joints, scribes and worn edges.
- ☐ Reattach any strip lighting that can be seen.
- ☐ Cupboard doors and plinths straight and aligned.
- ☐ Taps and plugs discoloured: respray.
- ☐ Test every appliance works.
- ☐ Regrout the splashback where needed.

WINDOWS AND DOORS

- ☐ Caulk around every window and door.
- ☐ Escutcheon plates fitted to every door handle.
- ☐ Door thresholds fitted correctly and secure.
- ☐ Window handles fitted and every window opens.
- ☐ Repaint and gloss the window sills.
- ☐ Coloured window frames: where white paint has got into the grain, repaint all frames.
- ☐ Blinds fitted with no missing slats. Check early for stains and tell the cleaner. If they can't be cleaned, reorder through Sunset Blinds.

ELECTRICAL AND LIGHTING

- ☐ Change bulbs so every room has the same colour temperature.
- ☐ Caulk around electrical faceplates.
- ☐ Every electrical faceplate secure to the wall, not loose.

COMPLETION

- ☐ Remove all materials and tools.
- ☐ Give the home a brief surface wipe and brush through to help the cleaners.
- ☐ Return the keys to the office.

REPORT Report, don’t hide

IF YOU FIND	WHAT TO DO
Blinds stained	Tell the cleaner before the clean; if they can’t be cleaned, reorder through Sunset Blinds
Appliance not working	Tell the office the same day
Anything beyond the checklist and N3 that will delay move-in	Tell the Voids & Works Manager the same day
Stock running low	Tell the office before it runs out

STOCK

Stock is your responsibility. Tell the office when anything is running low — before it runs out — so materials are ordered in good time.

Sign the N3

Open **NicoNet › SOP › Voids**, watch the film, read the standards and sign at the bottom. Your signature is recorded with the date and time on your staff file. You sign again whenever the N3 changes.

KIT What you carry, every job

- ☐ Uniform: decorators suit, t-shirt, jumper
- ☐ Dust sheets
- ☐ White silicone and caulk
- ☐ Grout and grout rake
- ☐ Colour-fill
- ☐ White bath trim
- ☐ Shower screen seals
- ☐ Tap and plug respray
- ☐ Gloss for sills
- ☐ Matching-colour-temperature bulbs
- ☐ Escutcheon plates
- ☐ Brush and cloths for the hand-over wipe

THE APP

8 Using NicoNet for void work

QUESTION	ANSWER
How do I sign in?	Your work email, then the six-digit code we email you. No password.
Where is my prep?	Work › Move-in prep. Only preps issued to you are shown.
The walk-through will not play	Check your signal; it streams. Ask the office if it still will not play.
I can't tick a line	Every line needs an after photo first: Take after photo and tick.
"N lines still to tick"	The hand-over waits until every line is ticked.
The camera does not open	Settings › NicoNet › Camera: allow.
I handed over too early	Tell the office straight away; the manager can send lines back to you.
A line is someone else's trade	Tell the manager in Messages; it may become an extra-works job.
Materials	Request in Work › Materials & orders; Paul approves every purchase; quote the PO and photograph the receipt.

SIGN-OFF

Acknowledgement

I confirm that I have read this Voids workflow guide in full, that I understand how my work reaches me in NicoNet, the steps I must follow and the standards I am held to, and that I will follow them on every job.

I understand that the app records the times I start and stop, my position when I do, my photos and my reports, and that this record is used to manage the work, to evidence it to residents, councils, ombudsmen and courts, and at my appraisal. I understand that a job I have not closed in the app is not complete, and that I will not be credited with it.

Name (block capitals) _____ Signature _____

Date _____ Line manager _____

Return the signed page to Kevin Sharp, or sign the N3 in NicoNet › SOP where the same acknowledgement is recorded on your file.